

Jierui Li

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EDUCATION

Xidian University & Virginia Tech Joint Program

Sep 2023 – Expected Jun 2027

- B.S. in Big Data Management and Application
- GPA: 3.8/4.0
- Relevant Coursework: Linear Algebra, Probability Theory, Database, Python, Data Mining

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Embodied AI, Vision-Language Robot Learning, Long-Horizon Task Reasoning, Interactive Multimodal Agents

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

BLENDER Lab, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Apr 2026 – Present

Advised by Prof. Heng Ji

- Proposed FurniAnchor, a zero-shot vision-language reasoning framework for manual-guided furniture assembly, converting instruction manuals into atomic assembly operations and enabling target-free 6D pose reasoning; co-first-authored manuscript under review at AAAI 2026.
- Conceptualized a multi-agent procurement framework for biomedical laboratory equipment.

Natural Language Processing Laboratory, Tsinghua University

Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

Advised by Prof. Zhiyuan Liu and Prof. Xin Yi

- Proposed RMHackBench, a mechanism-oriented benchmark for diagnosing reward hacking in vision-language reward models; manuscript under review through ACL Rolling Review (August 2026 cycle).

HPC-AI Lab, National University of Singapore

Dec 2025 – Feb 2026

Advised by Prof. Yang You

- Contributed to the development of GroupToM-Bench, a benchmark for evaluating group-level Theory of Mind in multi-agent and multimodal large language models; accepted to the ACL 2026 Main Conference as an Oral paper.

National Key Laboratory of Cognitive Intelligence, University of Science and Technology of China

Aug 2025 – Sep 2025

Mentored by Dr. Zhi Zheng

- Proposed a fine-grained drift modeling framework based on unmixed representations for online time series forecasting under delayed feedback; manuscript under review at WSDM 2026.

Laboratory of Intelligent Perception and Image Understanding, Xidian University

Dec 2024 – Oct 2025

Advised by Prof. Hao Zhu

- Proposed RouteGraph-Mona, a parameter-efficient fine-tuning framework for mineral image classification that combines sample-adaptive routing, class-wise route anchors, and confusion-aware route-space regularization; accepted at PRICAI 2026.
- Contributed to the design of SFPN (Shape Feature Preservation Network) for shape-aware feature modeling in building change detection; manuscript under review at TGRS.

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS

GroupToM-Bench: Benchmarking Group Theory of Mind and Nonlinear Social Emergence in MLLMs

ACL Main Conference 2026

Oral

Weidong Tang, **Jierui Li**, Yueling Hou, Zihan Mei, Zhang Can, Xinyan Wan, Zhiyuan Liang, Pengfei Zhou, Wangbo Zhao, Yang You*

We propose GroupToM-Bench, the first multimodal multi-agent benchmark for group-level Theory of Mind in MLLMs, with a seven-level cognitive framework for reasoning from individual intentions to collective outcomes.

RouteGraph-Mona: Confusion-Aware Routing Fine-Tuning for Mineral Image Classification

PRICAI 2026

Accepted

Jierui Li[†], Zhiyuan Qi[†], Hao Zhu, Yufan Liu, Jixian Liu, Shaojie Jiang, Yaqi Liu, Xiaotong Li*, Wei Wang*

We propose RouteGraph-Mona, a parameter-efficient fine-tuning framework for mineral image classification. Built upon Mona, it replaces static multi-scale aggregation with sample-adaptive routing and regularizes routing signatures using class-wise route anchors and an online confusion graph, improving separation among visually confusing mineral categories across multiple public benchmarks.

FurniReason: Zero-Shot Vision-Language Reasoning for Manual-Guided Furniture Assembly

AAAI 2027

Under Review

Zhiyuan Qi[†], **Jierui Li**[†], Yifan Shen, Cheng Qian, Jiateng Liu

We propose FurniReason, a zero-shot framework for manual-guided furniture assembly that recovers atomic assembly operations from manuals and performs target-free 6D pose reasoning through multi-view candidate-state refinement.

Fine-Grained Drift Modeling via Unmixed Representations for Online Time Series Forecasting

WSDM 2026

Under Review

Jierui Li, Weidong Tang, Jixian Liu, Shuning Zhang, Zhi Zheng*, Lingxing Kong

We propose Unmix Drift, a fine-grained drift modeling framework for online time series forecasting that addresses concept drift under feedback delay by decomposing non-stationary series into latent concept prototypes and leveraging unmixed representations to detect drift direction and intensity before labels arrive.

CueShiftBench: How Heuristic Cues Shape Multimodal Reward Evaluation

ACL ARR 2026 August Submission

Under Review

Jierui Li, Yueling Hou, Zhiyuan Qi, Bo Zhang, Ziqi Ma, Jixian Liu, Wenye Ban, Shuning Zhang, Yifan Shen, Weidong Tang, Qian Jiang, Xin Yi, Lingxing Kong

We propose CueShiftBench, a benchmark for systematically analyzing how heuristic cues shape multimodal reward evaluation and revealing shortcut-driven behaviors in vision-language reward models.

FedOLORA: Demand-Aware Recycling of Fixed-Capacity Orthogonal Memory for Federated Continual LoRA

AAAI 2027

Under Review

Zhuodong Liu[†], **Jierui Li**[†], Tianzuo Yuan, Xiangyu Li

We propose FedOLORA, a federated class-incremental learning framework that formulates orthogonal protection as fixed-capacity memory allocation for continual LoRA. It registers gauge-invariant product-space directions, estimates incoming-client demand, and dynamically recycles low-value protected subspaces under a hard stream-independent budget, preserving model plasticity while substantially reducing protection-state storage.

CoTAC: Collaborative Contextualization, Tokenization, and Calibration for Multimodal Generative Recommendation

AAAI 2027

Under Review

Zhuodong Liu[†], Yunhe Ni[†], **Jierui Li**[†], Yuchen Zhang, Peiyu Hu

We propose CoTAC, a multimodal generative recommendation framework that addresses the content-collaboration mismatch by carrying shared collaborative evidence through item representation, Semantic-ID tokenization, and autoregressive generation. It combines neighbor-aware multimodal contextualization, compatibility-regularized residual quantization, and prefix-conditioned soft alignment, achieving consistent improvements across four Amazon benchmarks.

Shape Feature Preservation Network for Building Change Detection

IEEE Transactions on Geoscience and Remote Sensing

Under Review

Xiaotong Li*, Jianda Wang, Haoyu Wang, Hao Zhu, **Jierui Li**, Huihui Dong, Biao Hou

We propose a novel network named SFPN, which effectively addresses jagged edges and misclassification caused by interfering backgrounds in building change detection through multi-scale feature enhancement and a collaborative dual-task design.